



Beyond Windows

How to navigate Mac, ChromeOS and Linux platforms

Why Apple Silicon at all? Apple's M-series SoCs pair fast CPU/GPU/NPU with unified memory and excellent efficiency. Result: instant wake, cool/quiet operation, long runtimes, and strong single-app responsiveness – great for mobile work and creative apps.

MacBook Air (fanless, ultraportable):

- **Strengths:** Class-leading battery life in light-to-moderate workloads; silent; thin and light; perfect for writing, Office/Google Workspace, coding, photo edits, light video, and meetings on the move.
- **Limits:** Sustained heavy loads (long renders/encodes) will throttle earlier than a Pro; fewer ports; memory and storage are not user-upgradeable – configure wisely at purchase.

MacBook Pro (active cooling, creator-class):

- **Strengths:** Sustains high performance under long renders, compiles, and multi-layer timelines; brighter/better calibrated displays; more ports (including HDMI/SD on many configs); larger batteries; better speakers/mics.
- **Limits:** Cost and weight; still no user RAM/GPU upgrades; gaming library on macOS is growing but smaller than Windows.

App compatibility on macOS:

- **Native universal apps:** The major creative suites, browsers, comms tools, DAWs, dev stacks, and many utilities ship Apple Silicon builds – performance is excellent.
- **Rosetta 2 translation:** Smoothly runs most older Intel-mac apps with small overhead. Good stopgap; not a forever plan – prefer native where available.